Rave Generation

KNOCK

Ultimate Techno Bassdrum

User Manual

Overview

Knock is a TR-909-based bassdrum synthesizer with transient shaping, analog-modeled drive, and a built-in reverb send. Designed for electronic music production, it delivers everything from classic house kicks to hard-hitting techno bassdrums in a single plugin.

Features include dual oscillator modes (Classic and ALT), 909-style click generator, six tick transient types (Classic, FM, Noise, HP, Chirp, Metal), adjustable body waveshaper, independent pitch sweep depth, a dedicated Punch FX section with multiple filter types and distortion algorithms, one-knob output drive with coloration, adjustable highpass filter, Clip 0dB protection, a built-in RRV-10 reverb send with 9 modes, a full Mackie-style strip EQ, a sample layer for layering samples on top of the synthesized kick, and a master output control.

Signal Flow

MIDI Note → 909 Oscillator → Body Waveshaper → Click/Body/Snap/Tick Transients → Punch FX → Tone Shaping + HP Filter → Sample Layer → Strip EQ → Reverb Send → Bus Saturation → Smart Clip → Master Output

The bassdrum signal starts with the oscillator (Classic or ALT mode), optionally shaped by the body waveshaper for added harmonic content. Pitch is controlled by attack, decay, hold envelopes and the independent sweep depth parameter. Transient layers (click, body, snap, tick) are added on top, with six tick type characters available. The signal then passes through the Punch FX section for additional character, followed by tone shaping with drive, coloration filters, and an adjustable highpass filter.

Next, the sample layer output is mixed in. The combined signal passes through the Mackie-style Strip EQ (with configurable routing for the sample layer). An additive reverb send adds space, followed by analog bus saturation to keep the output naturally bounded. Clip 0dB ensures clean output when enabled. Finally, the Master output knob controls the overall level.

CORE Section

The Core section contains the fundamental 909 bassdrum synthesis engine and transient controls.

Oscillator Controls

TUNE: Controls the pitch sweep time of the kick. Higher values produce a longer, more pronounced pitch drop at the start of each hit. Works together with SWEEP to shape the attack character.

SWEEP: Controls the pitch sweep depth (how far the frequency drops). At 0% there is no pitch sweep, producing a pure sub tone. At 33% (default) it matches the original 909 behavior. Higher values create increasingly aggressive pitch chirps, reaching laser/Simmons territory at 100%. Works together with TUNE to shape the attack character.

ATTACK: Controls the initial transient loudness. Higher values produce a sharper, more prominent click at the start of the kick.

DECAY: Controls how long the bassdrum rings out. Higher values produce longer, more sustained kicks.

HOLD: Sets the hold time (0–100 ms) before the decay begins. The sound stays at full volume for this duration before fading out. Creates a fatter, more sustained kick at higher values.

BODY: Adds weight and low-end presence to the kick. Crank it up for a heavier, more powerful sound.

SNAP: Controls the snap transient level. Adds a sharp, clicky attack for cut-through in a mix.

LEVEL: Master velocity/level control for the bassdrum output.

Switches

OSCILLATOR: Selects between Classic (authentic 909 triangle tone) and ALT (cleaner, sine-like tone).

CLICK: Selects the click character. Classic gives the original 909 click sound, ALT provides a punchier, harder-edged alternative.

MIDI: Toggles chromatic MIDI note tracking. When ON, the oscillator follows incoming MIDI note pitch, allowing melodic/chromatic playing.

TUNE x2: Doubles the tuning range for higher-pitched kicks.

DECAY x2: Doubles the decay time range for longer, boomy kicks.

PUNCH Section

The Punch section adds 909-style transient processing with filter and distortion effects.

Controls

TICK: Controls the tick transient level, adding a sharp percussive click at the very start of the sound.

TIME: Sets the duration of the punch envelope. Short values create tight snaps, longer values create more drawn-out transient tails.

FREQ: Sets the frequency for the punch filter.

RESO: Filter resonance amount. Higher values create more aggressive, resonant character.

GRIT: Controls the distortion intensity within the punch section.

TONE: Shapes the tonal balance of the punch effect.

MIX: Blends the punch effect with the dry kick signal.

Selectors

TICK TYPE: Selects the tick transient character. Classic is the original 2kHz sine burst. FM produces a metallic FM-synthesized tick that tracks the oscillator pitch. Noise is a filtered noise burst for airy presence. HP is a highpass-filtered impulse for a sharp crack. Chirp is a fast downward pitch sweep for an electronic zap. Metal produces inharmonic bell-like partials for an industrial metallic texture.

FILTER: Selects the punch filter type: Off (bypass), LP (lowpass), HP (highpass), or BP (bandpass).

ALGO: Selects the punch distortion algorithm: Tube (warm valve saturation), Tape (magnetic tape compression), Clip (hard clipping), or Fold (wavefolding).

TONE Section

The Tone section provides waveshaping, drive, coloration, highpass filtering, and level control.

Controls

SHAPE: Body waveshaper that adds harmonic richness to the oscillator tone. At 0% the oscillator is untouched. As you increase SHAPE, the waveform is progressively morphed from sinusoidal to parabolic, adding warm even harmonics that fatten and thicken the kick body. Inspired by the Jomox MBase Harmonics parameter.

DRIVE: One-knob distortion with a warm, tube-like character. Smoothly goes from clean to crunchy across the full range.

HI MID: Adds or removes midrange presence around 2.4 kHz. Most effective with the Classic oscillator which has richer harmonics.

HIGH: Brightens or darkens the overall tone by adjusting high-frequency content.

HP FREQ: Sets the frequency of the highpass (lo-cut) filter, ranging from 5 Hz to 200 Hz. Default is 75 Hz. Only active when HP POSITION is set to Pre or Post in the Strip EQ section. Use lower values to preserve sub energy, higher values to tighten the low end.

VOLUME: Master output level control.

CLIP 0dB: Enables Clip 0dB protection. Prevents the output from exceeding 0 dB to avoid digital clipping.

STRIP EQ Section

The Strip EQ section provides a Mackie-style channel strip with gain, parametric EQ, shelving filters, and a highpass filter.

GAIN: Input gain with analog console saturation (0–40 dB). Drives the signal harder into the Mackie-style preamp circuit as gain increases.

HI SHEL / LO SHEL: High and low shelving EQ (±15 dB). Broad tonal shaping for the top and bottom end of the kick.

HI MID / LO MID: Parametric mid-band EQ (±15 dB) with adjustable frequency and Q. Two independent bands for precise tonal sculpting.

HP POSITION: Enables the highpass (lo-cut) filter and selects its position in the signal chain. Off disables the filter. Post places it after the gain stage (traditional Mackie behavior). Pre places it before the gain stage, preventing low-frequency energy from hitting the preamp saturation. Use Pre when working with very low HP FREQ values to avoid resonant slamming.

EQ IN: Enables or disables the entire EQ section. When off, only the gain stage and console saturation are active. Note: when HP POSITION is set to Pre, the highpass filter remains active even with EQ IN off.

SAMPLE Section

The Sample section provides a one-shot sample layer that triggers in sync with the kick. It can be used to layer punch, click, and transient samples on top of the synthesized 909 core for extra attack character and texture. Samples come from an embedded sample bank or custom WAV files.

Controls

LEVEL: Controls the mix level of the sample layer into the kick signal.

PITCH: Pitch shift in semitones (-24 to +24). Adjusts the playback pitch of the selected sample.

DECAY: Amplitude decay envelope for the sample. Lower values create shorter, tighter transients; higher values let more of the sample tail through.

HPF: Highpass filter for the sample signal. Removes low-frequency content from the sample to avoid muddying the sub frequencies of the synthesized kick.

LPF: Lowpass filter (tone control) for the sample. Shapes the brightness of the sample from dark to bright.

OFFSET: Sample timing offset in milliseconds (0-10 ms). Controls when the sample triggers relative to the kick. Default is 1.2 ms (aligned with the kick transient). Lower values trigger earlier, higher values trigger later.

Selectors

SAMPLE: Selects which sample to layer from the 50 included samples. The first option (Off) disables the sample layer entirely.

STRIP EQ: Controls how the sample is routed through the Strip EQ section. Off: the sample bypasses the strip entirely and is mixed in after strip processing. EQ: the kick gets the gain stage first, then the sample is mixed in and both pass through the EQ stage together. EQ+Gain: the sample goes through the entire strip (gain + EQ) together with the kick.

Switches and Additional Controls

PHASE: Flips the polarity of the sample signal. Useful for aligning phase between the sample and the synthesized kick to avoid cancellation or to shape the combined transient.

VEL: Velocity sensitivity for the sample layer. At 0, the sample plays at full volume regardless of MIDI velocity. At higher values, softer hits produce a quieter sample layer.

POGO: Pitch bend envelope in semitones (-24 to +24). Applies a pitch envelope to the sample playback, sweeping the pitch up or down at the start of each hit for additional transient character.

SEND FX Section

The Send FX section provides a built-in reverb effect based on the RRV-10 vintage reverb engine, plus the master output control.

Controls

PRE-DLY: Pre-delay time before the reverb effect begins. Adds separation between the dry kick and the reverb tail.

TIME: Reverb decay time (stepped 0-15). Controls how long the reverb rings out.

TONE: Shapes the reverb tone. Turn left for darker, warmer tails. Turn right for brighter, more present reverb. Center position is neutral.

DRIVE: Adds drive and saturation to the reverb signal for a grittier, more colored reverb tail.

SEND: Controls the reverb send level. This is additive (not a dry/wet mix), so the dry signal always passes through at full level.

TAIL: Controls how the reverb tail behaves on each new MIDI note trigger. Off lets the reverb ring naturally with full buildup between hits. Reset clears the reverb buffer on each trigger for a clean tail per hit. Duck uses a sidechain envelope follower on the dry kick to duck the reverb tail, letting it swell back up after each hit for a pumping, breathing effect.

Selectors

REVERB: Selects the reverb algorithm: Room 1, Room 2, Hall 1, Hall 2, Plate 1, Plate 2, M Tap 1, M Tap 2, or Gated. Each mode offers a different spatial character from tight rooms to expansive halls and rhythmic multi-tap delays.

Master Output

MASTER: Final master output level control. This knob sits at the end of the entire signal chain, after the reverb send and smart clip. At 50% (12 o'clock) the output is at unity gain. Turn up for additional headroom boost (up to +6 dB), turn down to attenuate the final output.

Quick Start

Classic 909 kick:
Set OSCILLATOR to Classic, TUNE around 0.5, DECAY to taste. Add BODY for weight, SNAP for attack.

Hard techno kick:
Drive the DRIVE to 40-60%, enable CLIP 0dB. Push SWEEP above 50% for aggressive pitch character. Try SHAPE at 30-50% for a fatter body. Use the PUNCH section with LP filter and Tube algo. Set TICK TYPE to HP or Metal for hard-hitting transients. Set SEND FX TAIL to Reset for clean reverb per hit.

Deep room kick:
Set SEND FX to Room 1 or Room 2, TIME around 5-8, SEND at 20-30%. Turn TONE left for a dark, subby reverb tail.

Gated reverb kick:
Select Gated reverb mode, TIME at 3-5, SEND at 40-60%. Creates a tight, punchy reverb that cuts off sharply.

Clean sub kick:
Use ALT oscillator for a pure sine-like tone. Turn SWEEP to 0% for zero pitch drop. Keep DRIVE, SHAPE, and PUNCH minimal. Lower DECAY for a tight sub hit.

Layered transient kick:
Combine SNAP, TICK, and BODY for complex transient layering. Use PUNCH TIME to shape the transient envelope length. Try different TICK TYPEs for unique attack flavors. Add a sample layer with LEVEL around 30-50% for extra impact. Adjust OFFSET to fine-tune the sample timing relative to the kick transient.

Sample-enhanced kick:
Select a sample from the SAMPLE selector. Set LEVEL to taste and PITCH to 0 for natural pitch. Use HPF to filter out sub content from the sample so it doesn't interfere with the kick's low end. Route through STRIP EQ set to EQ for unified tonal shaping. Try PHASE flip if the combined sound feels thin - phase alignment can make a big difference.

Technical Notes

The Classic oscillator is modeled after the original TR-909 bassdrum circuit for authentic sound and dynamics. The ALT oscillator uses a different synthesis method for a cleaner, purer tone.

Velocity response is modeled after the original hardware for authentic dynamics.

The reverb engine is modeled after the BOSS RV-10 for an authentic vintage reverb character.

The output drive is designed for a warm, tube-like character without unwanted volume jumps.

Clip 0dB uses a two-stage approach for transparent limiting that prevents clipping without audible artifacts.

HI MID and HIGH controls are most effective with the Classic oscillator. The ALT oscillator produces a nearly pure tone with fewer harmonics to shape.

The SHAPE waveshaper adds even harmonics (primarily 2nd harmonic) by morphing the oscillator waveform from sinusoidal to parabolic. This is applied before the diode clip stage in the signal chain, so it interacts with the existing saturation for rich harmonic results.

The six tick types each use different synthesis methods: Classic uses a 2kHz sine burst, FM uses two-operator FM synthesis, Noise uses filtered white noise, HP uses a highpass-filtered impulse, Chirp uses a fast pitch-swept oscillator, and Metal uses four inharmonic sine partials at bell-like frequency ratios.

The sample layer triggers a one-shot sample in sync with each MIDI note. Samples are pitch-shifted using variable-rate playback and filtered through independent highpass and lowpass stages. The STRIP EQ routing selector controls whether the sample passes through the Mackie strip's gain and/or EQ stages or bypasses them entirely.

The analog bus saturation stage after the reverb send provides gentle soft-clipping above 0.9, preventing harsh digital overs while maintaining punch. The smart clip acts as a safety net below this stage.

The Master output control sits at the very end of the chain, after the smart clip, allowing final level adjustment without affecting any processing stages.

Support

For technical support, updates, and additional information: ravegeneration.io